

LIVE LONG AND PROSPER

Our quest to realize our body and mind's true health potential begins with keeping the harmful effects of our interaction with technology at bay

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Kartik Kulkarni is a bemused young man. Born in the '80s, he's part of the generation that first-hand saw the explosion of digital technology into our homes, here in India and around the world. As technology broke one formidable barrier after another – be it in the way Kartik communicated, sought information, entertained himself and got things done to live his life – he couldn't help but notice that the world was coming together, becoming smaller and getting in his reach better than ever before. Kulkarni admits, with a wry smile, a reality that not only him but everyone faced while adjusting and adapting to life in the digital age. Health. Not just physical but mental health.

From getting his first computer in the mid '90s as a teenager, getting hooked on to reading technology magazines, slowly substituting the time spent outdoors playing real sports with video games on the television or his PC, and other such digital digressions. Slowly but surely, Kartik's life was taking a major turn onto the digital highway. Consuming an overwhelming amount of digital content at an early age made Kartik innately different than his parents' generation in more ways than one. Later in the new millennium, as smart devices started cropping up and the internet became accessible to one and all, Kartik Kulkarni, much like Alice (in Wonderland) fell even deeper



Working those late nights and not grabbing enough sleep can impact you adversely

into the rabbit hole of the digital era, until he realized that there's no escaping from it. He was mesmerized by technology at first, marvelling at its novelty and slowly getting enamoured by its ubiquity.

Kartik started suffering from the side-effects of adjusting to an overdependent tech lifestyle. Hours spent playing video games and working on his PC led to a rapid deterioration of his eyesight and

he attracted spectacles while still in his teens. An increasingly sedentary lifestyle became the dominating feature of Kartik's existence, where he started putting on weight and growing sideways much more than was desirable – the lean and fit boy who conquered the district trophy by playing a crucial role in his school's winning cricket team was lost in the shadows. Online friends became the dominating